

KOI on Cortex XSIAM

Choosing Your Deployment

Two supported options, compared — so you can pick on evidence rather than assertion

Option A	Custom KOI integration + Custom content pack (26 commands)
Option B	Marketplace KOI integration + KOI Content Extension (13 commands)
Applies to	Cortex XSIAM
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Both options are real, working deployments. This document sets out what each gives you, what it does not, and which questions should decide it.

Contents

1. The Decision in Short

The two options differ in one root way: how much of KOI's API the integration exposes. Everything else follows from that.

	Option A — Custom	Option B — Marketplace
KOI commands	26	13
Integration source	Delivered directly by us	Published in the Cortex Marketplace
Updates	We ship you a new pack version	Marketplace update path for the integration
Device investigation	Yes	Not available — no device commands
Independent catalog risk	Yes — Koidex risk report and search	Not available
Remediation / approval history	Yes	Not available
Runtime (hardening) policy visibility	Yes	Not available
Alert fields, type and layout in the UI	Notification id only	Full — 19 fields, type and layout
Governed allow / block lists	Yes	Yes
Inventory and search	Yes	Yes
Event collection into XSIAM	Yes, with fetch-time de-duplication	Yes

The short version

- **Choose A if investigation depth matters.** Only A can answer "what else is on this host", "what does the catalog independently say about this item", and "what has already been done about it".
- **Choose B if vendor-published supply chain matters more than depth.** The integration comes from the Marketplace and updates through it; the extension content adds a purpose-built alert UI on top.

A is the more capable option and this document does not pretend otherwise — but B is not a cut-down A. It carries alert-UI content that A does not ship today, and its integration has a supply chain some organisations require.

2. What Both Options Give You

These 13 commands are identical in both — same names, same arguments, same outputs. Content written against one runs against the other.

Capability	Commands
Event collection into koi_koi_raw	koi-get-events
Software inventory across the estate	koi-inventory-list, koi-inventory-item-get, koi-inventory-search
Which endpoints carry a given item	koi-inventory-item-endpoints-list
Organisation allow list	koi-allowlist-get, -items-add, -items-remove
Organisation block list	koi-blocklist-get, -items-add, -items-remove

Capability	Commands
Policy visibility and enable / disable	koi-policy-list, koi-policy-status-update

Both options also ship the same shape of XSIAM content: parsing and modeling rules that normalise KOI events to the Cortex Data Model, an alerts dashboard, alert triage and investigation playbooks, an analyst-gated response playbook, and the Script Runner that executes KOI deployment scripts across the fleet on a schedule.

So the baseline is genuinely equal. The difference is what sits above it.

3. What Only the Custom Option Gives You

Thirteen further commands, and the capabilities they make possible. This is the whole of the difference in KOI reach.

Capability	Commands	What it lets an analyst do
Device-centred investigation	koi-devices-list, koi-device-inventory-get, koi-groups-list	Answer "what else is installed on this host, and how risky is any of it". Without these there is no device investigation at all.
Independent threat intelligence	koi-koidex-risk-report, koi-koidex-search	Get a catalog risk score, findings and an AI-written risk summary for any item — including one nobody has installed yet.
Response history	koi-remediations-list, koi-approval-requests-list	See what has already been remediated or requested for an item before deciding to block it.
Runtime hardening posture	koi-runtime-policies-list, koi-runtime-policy-get	Review agent enforcement policies and their full rule tree.
Finding vocabulary	koi-findings-list	Resolve the finding identifiers that appear in alerts into their definitions.
Identity	koi-users-list	List KOI users for attribution.
Collection diagnostics	koi-fetch-context-get, koi-fetch-context-set	Inspect and correct the collector's high-water-mark when investigating a collection gap.

Why this changes the automation, not just the command list

- Verdicts are corroborated. Triage weighs KOI's own alert data against the independent catalog risk, instead of relying on the alert alone.
- Device investigation exists. An alert on a host expands into everything installed there and what is risky about it.
- The approval gate shows history. An analyst approving an organisation-wide block sees prior remediations and approvals, not just the item.
- Collection problems are diagnosable in place, without opening a support case to find out where the collector stopped.

Data collection differences

Behaviour	Detail
Fetch-time de-duplication	KOI re-sends every still-open alert on each fetch. The custom integration de-duplicates within the batch and across cycles, so one alert is one alert. Without it, alert rows inflate substantially and any count over them is wrong.
Multi-tenant attribution	Each event is stamped with the KOI tenant name and customer id, so several KOI tenants can share one dataset and stay distinguishable.
Promoted columns	About thirty fields are lifted out of the raw JSON — item, device, MCP and governance attributes — so they are directly queryable.
Threat-hunting library	72 saved XQL queries: 26 hunts and 46 detections across KOI and Cortex XDR data.

4. What Only the Marketplace Option Gives You Today

Stated plainly, because it is a real advantage and it is the half of this comparison a vendor usually leaves out.

Advantage	Why it matters
A vendor-published integration	The integration is distributed and versioned through the Cortex Marketplace. Some organisations require that supply chain for anything that holds an API key.
Alert fields, type and layout	19 KOI fields are written onto each alert and presented in a purpose-built layout, so an analyst sees item, risk, host, governance and verdict on the alert itself rather than in the war room.
Proactive hunt automation	A scheduled hunt sweep that runs several hunts, investigates what it finds, and routes candidates to an analyst-gated block.
Supply-chain gateway content	Triage for gateway approval requests — the exception a user files after the gateway blocks an install. Available on request; not part of the standard release.

The alert-UI content is portable to the custom option and is planned. If the alert layout is decisive for you, ask us for the current status before choosing on that basis alone.

5. Operational and Lifecycle Differences

	Option A — Custom	Option B — Marketplace
How you receive it	Sent to you directly as pack source or a pack zip	Integration from the Marketplace; extension content sent directly
Install method	demisto-sdk upload (required for working event collection)	Marketplace install, then the extension by SDK upload
Who maintains the integration	Us	The Marketplace publisher
Getting a fix	We ship a new pack version	Integration fixes follow the publisher's release cycle
Customisation	Open to change — it is your pack	The integration is fixed; the content around it is open to change

	Option A — Custom	Option B — Marketplace
Prerequisites	KOI API key, an egress IP KOI accepts, Core REST API integration enabled	Same

Both options require an egress IP that KOI accepts. KOI restricts its sensitive endpoints by source address, so a tenant egressing from a shared cloud range can receive HTTP 403 with a perfectly valid API key. Where that applies, run the integration on a Cortex engine whose address KOI accepts. This is the single most common cause of a deployment appearing broken, and it affects both options equally.

6. Which Should You Choose

Four questions settle it in most cases.

Question	If yes	If no
Will analysts investigate the host, not just the item?	Option A — device investigation needs the custom commands	Either
Do you want a risk opinion independent of the alert itself?	Option A — the catalog risk report is custom-only	Either
Does policy require every integration to come from the Marketplace?	Option B	Either
Is the on-alert field layout needed on day one?	Option B today — ask us about the custom roadmap	Either

Our recommendation

Option A, unless a Marketplace-published integration is a hard requirement. The difference is not a longer feature list — it is whether an analyst can answer the next question without leaving Cortex. Device context, independent catalog risk and response history are what turn an alert into a decision, and none of the three is reachable with 13 commands.

If the Marketplace supply chain is mandatory, Option B is a sound deployment and we support it. You keep collection, inventory, governance, triage, the dashboard, the Script Runner and the alert UI. What you give up is depth of investigation, and it is worth agreeing up front how analysts will work without it.

Both options are described in full in their own customer guides. We are happy to run a side-by-side demonstration on your tenant before you decide.